Kevin Rajan

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Education

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign — Urbana-Champaign, IL
B.S. Engineering Physics, Minor in Computer Science — *Graduated May 2020*

Experience

Founder & CEO — Jun. 2024 – Present
zero, LLC — *Remote*

- Landed 41 commits on **NousResearch/hermes-agent** main (Aug.–Oct. 2026) across runtime correctness (cron, gateway watchdog, config signatures), context-compaction safety, kanban, desktop, and platform adapters; opened 194 PRs and 161 issues and commented on 1,272 threads upstream.
- Built **Hermes Tern**, a native terminal UI for Hermes (plan review, forked sessions, OpenUI previews, voice), and **Dash**, an Expo phone app plus Bun bridge over Tailscale that keeps one live thread per agent harness (Hermes, Codex, Claude Code, OMP, Grok); both in daily use.
- Designed **z0**, a registry and installer for a personal agent stack (evidence-routed decisions, typed intent contracts, token economics, reproducible evals), and a verified open-source loop (leased claims, isolated worktrees, evidence receipts, human merge); 151 merged PRs in 44 external projects.

LLM Training Specialist — Jan. 2025 – Present
Outlier (Scale AI) — *Remote*

- Designed and applied detailed rubrics for LLM evaluation, writing complex logic, math, and physics prompts to elicit reasoning failures and guide model improvement through process-supervision feedback. Performed red-teaming and fact-checking across STEM and general-knowledge domains, verifying claims with web sources and explaining weaknesses in model reasoning to refine future outputs.
- Conducted large-scale preference labeling and comparative ranking of multiple LLMs (RLHF, DPO, RLAIF) while drafting critiques that articulated why certain completions failed rubric standards. Developed multimodal and tool-use evaluations integrating text, image, and retrieval tasks to measure grounding, reliability, and reasoning depth across diverse model architectures.

Self-Directed Ultralearning — Jul. 2023 – Jun. 2024
Sabbatical — *Naperville, IL*

- Engineered a holistic performance optimization system to enhance cognitive and motor skills, applying an algorithmic feedback loop (Research, Implement, Analyze, Iterate) to systematically correlate and refine inputs, including sleep, nutrition, and specialized training protocols.
- Executed a long-term data-driven analysis project to benchmark and optimize rapid skill acquisition; successfully reverse-engineered complex, dynamic systems to identify and eliminate bottlenecks, culminating in validated performance metrics within the top 1–5% of a 25M+ user environment (Kovaaks, Valorant, Apex).

Senior Consultant, Technology Enablement — Jun. 2021 – Jul. 2023
Slalom Consulting — *Chicago, IL*

- Collaborated within a multi-disciplinary team to enhance client ($4B+ revenue finance firm) engagement while modernizing technology systems across 12 teams and verticals. Mitigated obstacles for business unit teams using enhanced software processes and workflows, promoting Agile/DevOps/CI/CD concepts by utilizing AWS, Jenkins, Terraform and Vault.
- Improved developer impact by creating tailored pipelines that publish biweekly golden Windows and RHEL releases, ultimately ensuring security standards within custom AMIs.
- Spearheaded the creation of a centralized knowledge base, curating exemplary business documents like SPROs, customer stories, qualifiers, and evaluations across technological and business administrative platforms to enhance company-wide accessibility post-sanitization and lay the groundwork for AI-driven content generation.
- Championed a comprehensive DevOps training program tailored for over 500 new hires, ensuring a smooth transition into the company's technology ecosystem. Designed an engaging onboarding session anchored around point poker, fostering collaboration and hands-on learning. Orchestrated multi-cloud environments to provide an interactive, holistic, real-world experience of the best practices we use with our clients.
- Steered the conceptualization of a preventative health platform acting as product owner. Orchestrated the amalgamation of diverse health data sources, from wearables to full metabolic/blood panels. Initiated outreach to several health tech leaders and experts to gather insights, shaping preliminary ideas for platform features. Prioritized areas of focus by aligning the platform with cutting-edge health research and its potential for predictive analysis and enhanced patient outcomes.

Prior Experience

Software Engineer May 2019 – Aug. 2019
Synchrony Financial *Chicago, IL*

AWS Developer (EC2 Fargate) Aug. 2018 – Jan. 2019
Amazon *Seattle, WA*

Technology Enterprise Architect Jun. 2018 – Aug. 2018
BlueCross BlueShield (HCSC) *Chicago, IL*

iOS Engineer / UX Engineer Jul. 2017 – Feb. 2018
Prenosis Inc. *Champaign, IL*

Software Engineering Intern May 2016 – Jul. 2016
Wipro Consulting *Chennai, India*

Freelance iOS Contractor / UI Designer Jan. 2016 – Jul. 2016
ByteBros. *Champaign, IL*

Projects

Quackles (Microduck product study) 2026

- Product page homage to the Hermes Agent poster: Blender Cycles plates in five themes and a 201 MP deep-zoom master served as a WebP tile pyramid.
- The same pyramid backs an infinite-canvas portfolio with semantic zoom: overview, summaries, details, then commit-level evidence.

HackIllinois 2015 – 2018

- Developed an iOS application that allows about 15k people (hackers, mentors, recruiters) to have a seamless experience during the 36-hour student-run hackathon, allowing them to check into events, check out hardware, and get food. Raised $300k+ from event sponsors for operational costs and prizes.
- Managed the open source initiative, a pilot program that expanded to become the main attraction for several leading technology firms and open source groups.

Technical Skills

DevOps: AWS, Terraform, Jenkins, Azure
Languages: Python, C++, C, Java, Haskell
AI & LLMs: Hermes Agent, Claude Code, Codex, OpenCode, ACP, MCP, context engineering, evals
Design: Photoshop, Figma, GIMP, Sketch, Zeplin
iOS: Xcode, Swift, jazzy-docs, cocoapods
Web: TypeScript, React, React Native/Expo, Electron, HTML, CSS, WebGL
3D: Maya, Unity, Blender, AfterEffects, Inventor, Unreal Engine
Data Analytics: pandas, Tableau, Cognos, PowerBI